

Rob Higgins

Tech Lead · Fullstack · Applied Research & Emerging Tech

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SUMMARY

Fullstack tech lead with 10+ years taking ambiguous 0–1 ideas from prototype to production. Led AR Enterprise Web SDK at Snap; Head of Engineering at Panorama AI for LLM/ML products. Strong in React, Node, Python, rapid experimentation, and agentic AI-assisted development.

EXPERIENCE

Panorama AI · Dec 2023 – Feb 2026 · Santa Monica, CA

Head of Engineering · Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Led data and platform teams behind LLM/ML products (Python, PostgreSQL, Redis, event ingestion); set architecture standards and mentored engineers.
- Drove 0–1 incubation of LLM BI capabilities, rapid prototypes validated with customers and hardened into production.

Lead Software Engineer · Dec 2023 – Oct 2024

- Built predictive recommendations and LLM BI infrastructure, React embeddables, and analytics on Redis, BigQuery, Athena, and PostgreSQL.

Snap Inc. · Jul 2021 – Sep 2023 · Santa Monica, CA

Software Engineer · AR Enterprise Web SDK Tech Lead

- Tech lead after Snap acquired Vertebrae; owned ARES Web SDK from prototype to production (API, merchant integrations, event tracking, templating).
- Built cross-cloud pub/sub linking Snap and Vertebrae; Redis for caching/real-time paths; shipped Camera Kit and Three.js experiences from spike to prod.

Vertebrae Inc. · Feb 2016 – Jul 2021 · Santa Monica, CA + Remote

Senior Fullstack Software Engineer

- Early engineer; repeatedly took unproven AR/VR e-commerce ideas from MVP to production through the Snap acquisition.
- Owned Terraform/Docker/microservices cloud infra at millions-of-users scale; Redis and MongoDB alongside PostgreSQL; shipped merchant SDK, React/Node tools, and CI/CD.

SKILLS

JavaScript / TypeScript · React · Node.js · Python · AI / LLM · Agentic Coding / MCP · Rapid Prototyping / 0–1 · System Design · Distributed Systems · PostgreSQL · Redis · MongoDB · BigQuery / Athena · AWS / GCP · Terraform · Docker / Kubernetes · Microservices · SDK & Developer Tools · Technical Leadership

EDUCATION

Full Sail University · AAS, Recording Arts Technology